Wang Xuance's exploits find no mention in Indian historical accounts, where the attempt to usurp Harsha's throne sounds more like a skirmish involving a minor vassal of the king. In a Politbureau meeting held on 6 October 1962, in advance of the outbreak of the Sino-India border war, Mao is reported to have referred to the 'one and a half wars' fought between India and China in history:

> The first war had been in 648 CE when a Tang dynasty emperor had dispatched troops to assist the legal claimant to a throne to a subcontinental kingdom after the other claimant had killed 300 members of a Tang diplomatic mission. A Tang strengthened force defeated the usurper who was captured and sent to the Tang capital Changan where he lived the rest of his life. [3]

Mao then referred to a 'half war' in 1398 when 'Timurlane captured Delhi. This was a great victory, but was followed by the slaughter of 100,000 prisoners and looting of all precious metals and gems across the land. This was a "half war" because Timur and his army were Mongols from both Inner and Outer Mongolia. Mongolia was then part of China, making the attack half Chinese.' [4]

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There is mostly a blank in Chinese historical documents thereafter as far as India is concerned, until we learn of a Chinese mission to the court of Sultan Muhammad Shah (Muhammad bin Tughlaq) in the year 1341 in the travel diaries of Ibn Battuta, a resident of Tangiers. The Chinese mission had come to Delhi, the Sultan's capital, to seek his intercession for the restoration of a Buddhist temple in Assam which Chinese pilgrims used to visit and to which the local ruler had apparently denied them access. The Sultan apparently demanded that this request be conveyed by the Chinese emperor personally before he agreed to proceed against the local ruler. Ibn Battuta, who was residing in Delhi at the time and serving as a judge appointed by the Sultan, was then asked to proceed to China as the Sultan's envoy along with the Chinese mission. Ibn Battuta finally made it to China after several years, but does not explain how. The original journey was ill-fated, as the Chinese vessels in which he was to travel to China from Calicut on the Malabar coast were cast adrift in a violent storm and sailed